

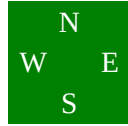
Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J T 9 7
 ♥ Q 6 5 2
 ♦ T 6 4
 ♣ 7 5

♠ A Q 4
 ♥ K 8 3
 ♦ K 9 5
 ♣ J 6 3 2



♠ K 6 5 3
 ♥ A 7 4
 ♦ Q 8 3
 ♣ A K 4

♠ 8 2
 ♥ J T 9
 ♦ A J 7 2
 ♣ Q T 9 8

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		1NT
All Pass 3NT by South			

winners established. If instead you play low, then South cannot get a second ♦ trick and will have to look elsewhere for his ninth trick. As you can see, he is not going to be able to find it.

Baker SecondHand 1

[show NE]

[showcards W:SJ]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♠J, won by dummy's ♠Q. The ♦5 is now played from dummy. What do you play?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[NEXT]

[show NESW]

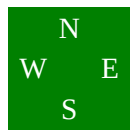
Play the ♦2. Considering that South opened 1NT, he must have the ♦Q for this play to make sense.

So if you put on your ♦A, South will have TWO ♦

Board 2
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ T 4
 ♥ J T 5 4
 ♦ 9 6 3
 ♣ J T 9 3

♠ A 6
 ♥ K 9 3
 ♦ A Q J 7 4
 ♣ K Q 7



♠ 9 7 5 3
 ♥ Q
 ♦ K T 5 2
 ♣ 8 6 5 4
 ♠ K Q J 8 2
 ♥ A 8 7 6 2
 ♦ 8
 ♣ A 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♦	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	3NT	Pass	4 ♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♥
Pass	6 ♥		
All Pass 6 ♥ by South			

finesse the ♥9 on the first trump play.

As it turns out, when you play low South calls for dummy's ♥K, East's ♥Q falls and you now have 2 trump tricks. If you had played the ! H10 you would have tossed away the setting trick.

Baker SecondHand 2
 [show NW]

[showcards E:C2 S:H2,CA]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Your lead of the ♣J was won by South with the ♣A. South then played the ♥2 and you must decide whether to split your honors.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
 [NEXT]

[show NESW]

[PLAY E:C2]

Play the ♥4, do not split your Honors.

South's bidding showed at least 5 ♥s, so assuming he holds both the ♥ A Q, it would be silly for him to

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J T 6 4
 ♥ K
 ♦ 7 6 4 2
 ♣ K Q 7 5

♠ K 7

♥ J 8 6 3 2

♦ K 5 3

♣ T 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 9 8 3 2

♥ Q 4

♦ T 9 8

♣ A 9 3

♠ A 5

♥ A T 9 7 5

♦ A Q J

♣ J 8 6

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♥

1♥

All Pass
 4♥ by South

Play the ♥4.

North has 5 ♥s and South must have at least 5. The reason you cover an Honor is that you hope to establish a lower card in either your hand or partner's hand. But your partner has one ♥ at the most so there is no hope of establishment.

Now that you have looked at the hands aren't you glad you didn't cover?

Baker SecondHand 3

[show NE]

[showcards S:DJ,CJ,C8,C6 W:D2,CK,CQ,C5]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣K, and you played the ♣9 to encourage him. He continued with the ♣Q, then a small card to your ♣A. You then exit with the ! D10, taken by dummy's ♦K.

Declarer then calls for the ♥J. Do you cover with your ♥Q or not?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
 [NEXT]

[show NESW]

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 3
 ♥ J T 8 5
 ♦ T 6
 ♣ 9 7 6 4

♠ A T 5

♥ Q 6 3

♦ 8 7 4 2

♣ J 8 5



♠ Q 9 7 4 2

♥ 9 4

♦ A K Q J

♣ A K

♠ 8 6

♥ A K 7 2

♦ 9 5 3

♣ Q T 3 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass 4 ♠ by South			

Play the ♠ 3.

If South decides to finesse the ♠ T then you will still win the one ♠ trick which you are entitled to win.

However, with South holding the ♠ Q it would be very logical for him to go up with the ♠ A then lead back toward his ♠ Q, playing East for the ♠ K. If he plays this way you will get two tricks and defeat the contract.

Baker SecondHand 4

[show NW]

[showcards E:HA,HK,H2 S:S4,S2,H9,H4]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♥ J, covered by dummy's ♥ Q and won by East's ♥ K. East wins the ♥ A at the second trick and continues with a small ♥ ruffed by South.

South then plays the ♠ 4 from his hand. Do you play low? or play the ♠ J to force dummy's ♠ A?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
 [NEXT]

[show NESW]

Board 5
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ 9 5 3
 ♥ 9 8 7 2
 ♦ 8 6 5 3
 ♣ K 6

♠ K 7 4
 ♥ A J T
 ♦ Q J 4
 ♣ Q J T 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A T 8
 ♥ K Q 4
 ♦ A K T
 ♣ A 9 8 2

♠ Q J 6 2
 ♥ 6 5 3
 ♦ 9 7 2
 ♣ 5 4 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	6NT		2NT
All Pass 6NT by South			

Baker SecondHand 5
 [show NE]

[showcards S:H4 W:H9]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥9, taken by dummy's ! H10. The ♠4 is then played from dummy. Do you play low? or split your honors?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
 [NEXT]

[show NESW]

Play the ♠J (or ♠Q).

You should always make a point count check as soon as you see dummy. South's 2NT promises 20 or 21 points, North has 14 and you have 3; total = 37 or 38. Therefore West must have either 2 or 3 points. He cannot have two Jacks because you can see all four of them. Likewise he cannot have a Queen because you can see three of them and his ♥ lead (top of nothing) denied that Queen.

It follows that West MUST have a King, and it must be ♣s or ♦s since he has denied any ♥ Honor.

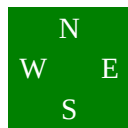
Since West will definitely win his King, you need to take one trick yourself, and the best way to do that is to split your Honors to establish one ♠ winner.

South has no defense to this, but if you had played low he would have played the ♠T and made the slam.

Board 6
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ T 9 8 2
 ♥ 9 6 3 2
 ♦ 5 3
 ♣ K Q 4

♠ K J 5
 ♥ Q 7 4
 ♦ T 7 2
 ♣ A J 9 5



♠ A Q 4
 ♥ A 8 5
 ♦ A Q 8 4
 ♣ 8 6 3

♠ 7 6 3
 ♥ K J T
 ♦ K J 9 6
 ♣ T 7 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		1NT
All Pass 3NT by South			

Baker SecondHand 6
 [show NW]

[showcards E:S3 S:SA,C3]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♠T; low cards from North and East, won by South with the ♠A.

South next plays the ♣3 and you must decide whether to split your ♣K Q.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
 [NEXT]

[show NESW]

Play the ♣4.

If you split your Honors, playing the ♣Q perhaps, dummy's ♣A will take the trick and South will later play through your ♣K toward dummy's ♣J 9 5. Played in this way he will establish 3 ♣ winners (which he needs for the contract).

If you play low, he MIGHT finesse the ♣J and again establish 3 ♣ winners. But South's correct play would be to put on dummy's ♣9, finessing West for the ♣T. This is because ♣K 10 or ♣Q 10 are twice as likely as ♣K Q.

If he does play this way East will win the ♣T and your ♣K Q will get one more trick.

Board 7

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 7 3

♥ T

♦ J T 9 8 5 2

♣ Q 5

♠ A K 9 4

♥ K Q 6

♦ A Q 4

♣ T 8 6



♠ T 6 2

♥ 7 3

♦ K 7 6 3

♣ A 9 4 2

♠ Q 5

♥ A J 9 8 5 4 2

♦ -

♣ K J 7 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

6 ♥

All Pass

6 ♥ by South

Play the ♣2.

You have a full count on South's hand. He started with 2 ♠s, 7 ♥s, and no ♦s. His other 4 cards must have been ♣s, and he has discarded 2 of them.

So he has 2 ♣s left in his hand. If one of them is the ♣K and you play your ♣A then you have handed him the contract.

By playing low you give him a guess to make. If he plays the ♣K he will make the contract, but if he plays the ♣J he will go down. He will probably play the ♣J, figuring you wouldn't have the nerve to duck with the ♣A. He'll know better next time he plays against you.

Baker SecondHand 7

[show NESW]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown, (wild).

Partner led the ♦J; ♦Q from dummy, ♦K from you and ruffed by South.

South then pulls two rounds of trumps, (West discards on the second one), followed by his ♠Q, dummy's ♠A K and dummy's ♦A. South discards ♣s on the last two cards.

The ♣6 is then played from dummy and you must make a decision - ♣A or ♣2?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
[NEXT]

Board 8

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 4
 ♥ 7 4
 ♦ J 9 7 5 4
 ♣ A J 3

♠ 8 6 2
 ♥ A K Q J T
 ♦ 8 3
 ♣ Q T 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 9 5
 ♥ 9 3
 ♦ A K Q
 ♣ K 9 7 5 2

♠ A T 7 3
 ♥ 8 6 5 2
 ♦ T 6 2
 ♣ 8 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

the first trick. So South has both of them. So with those 3 tricks and the 5 ♥s in dummy South only needs to find one more winner. Assuming he has the ♣K, (or why play the suit), if you play low he will find that one more winner whichever high ♣ he plays.

Next ask yourself "Where is the ♠A?" Clearly East DOES have this card; otherwise South has his 9 tricks.

So the way to beat the contract is to go up with your ♣A, then play ♠K, ♠Q and a third ♠, hoping East holds ♠ A x x x.

Baker SecondHand 8

[show NW]

[showcards S:DK,C9]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♦ 5; ♦ 3, ! D10 and won by South with ♦ K. South now leads the ♣ 9 from his hand and it is your play.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[NEXT]

[show NESW]

Play the ♣ A.

First ask yourself "Where are the ♦ A and ♦ Q?" East doesn't have either one or he would have played it at

Board 9

South Deals

None Vul

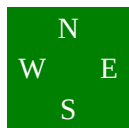
♠ 8 5 2
 ♥ A Q 6 4 3
 ♦ 7 4
 ♣ T 6 3

♠ A K

♥ T 9 7

♦ T 9 6 2

♣ K Q 8 5



♠ J 9 7 4 3

♥ 5 2

♦ A 8 5

♣ 9 7 4

♠ Q T 6

♥ K J 8

♦ K Q J 3

♣ A J 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

1NT

All Pass
 3NT by South

Baker SecondHand 9

[show NE]

[showcards S:S6,H8 W:S2,H4]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥4, won by South's ♥8.

South enters dummy with the ♠K and leads the !
 D10. What do you play?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
 [NEXT]

[show NESW]

Play the ♦ A.

You don't have much in your hand, but you do have the ♦ A, and you also have the responsibility to help West set up his suit.

So even though you don't know for sure how good that suit is, your plan of action should be to take the ♦ A and return a ♥.

As you see, this will defeat the contract. Had you played a low ♦ South would have pocketed that trick and added 4 ♣s and 3 ♠s to go with the ♥ he had already won.

Board 10

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K T 8 7 4

♥ J 8 7 2

♦ T 2

♣ K J

♠ 9 5 3

♥ A Q

♦ A 6

♣ Q T 9 8 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6 2

♥ T 9 4

♦ Q J 8 7 4

♣ A 7 4

♠ A Q J

♥ K 6 5 3

♦ K 9 5 3

♣ 6 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

Pass

1 ♦

Pass

2 ♣

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Baker SecondHand 10

[show NW]

[showcards E:S2 S:SQ,C6]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♠7; ♠3, ♠2 and won by South with ♠Q.

South then plays the ♣6 from his hand. Which ♣ should you play?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[NEXT]

[show NESW]

Play the ♣J.

You should not allow yourself to be misled by South winning the first trick with the ♠Q. East does not hold either the ♠A or the ♠J or he would have played it. South is just trying to be deceptive.

That means you need the next ♠ play to come from East, so you play your ♣J and let East win his ♣A. You can be sure East has the ♣A because South would have played the suit differently if he held the Ace.

East will win the ♣A and return his ♠ through South's ♠ A Q. This allows you to set up your ♠ suit while you still have the ♣K for an entry.

Board 11

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q T 8 5 3 2

♥ 7 3

♦ Q J T

♣ 9 4

♠ K 6

♥ 8 5 2

♦ 9 7 5 4 2

♣ Q 7 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7

♥ 9 6 4

♦ K 8 6 3

♣ J T 8 6 2

♠ A J 9 4

♥ A K Q J T

♦ A

♣ A K 5

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♣

Pass

3♥

Pass

6♥

All Pass
6♥ by South

Baker SecondHand 11

[show NE]

[showcards S:S4,DA W:S2,DQ]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♦Q, you signaled with the ♦8 and South won the ♦A.

South then played low to dummy's ♠K, and led dummy's ♠6. Your decision is not whether to play high or low, but whether to ruff or not, which amounts to the same thing.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[NEXT]

[show NESW]

Do not ruff.

Even though South holds the ♠A, if you ruff now he will just put on a small ♠ and you will be ruffing a loser. Instead discard a ♦.

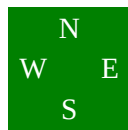
South will win the ♠A, but will not be able to ruff any ♠ losers in dummy because your trumps can overruff any of North's trumps.

Suppose you had ruffed the ♠. South would have played his ♠9, leaving himself with ♠ A J. He would then get the lead and pull your two remaining trumps. That would leave one trump in dummy to ruff his ♠J, his only remaining loser.

Board 12
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ Q 9 2
 ♥ Q 3
 ♦ Q J T 6
 ♣ K Q J 8

♠ J 6 3
 ♥ A K T 9 8
 ♦ 8 2
 ♣ T 9 4



♠ A T 7 4
 ♥ J 6 5 2
 ♦ 9 5 4
 ♣ 5 3

♠ K 8 5
 ♥ 7 4
 ♦ A K 7 3
 ♣ A 7 6 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	1NT
All Pass 1NT by South			

Baker SecondHand 12
 [show NW]

[showcards E:S4,C5,C3 S:H4,CA,C6,C2]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♣K and continue with the ♣J then ♣Q, taken by South's ♣A. To trick 4 South plays the ♥4. What do you play?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
 [NEXT]

[show NESW]

Play the ♥Q.

To see why you should play the ♥Q, just visualize the result if you play low. South will finesse with dummy's ♥8. If East wins his ♥J on this trick there will be 4 good ♥ tricks in dummy. If East withholds his ♥J then Declarer will have 3 ♥ winners.

Now visualize the result of playing the ♥Q. Whether South takes this trick or not he cannot win more than 2 ♥s.

Board 13
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ 9 7 6
 ♥ T 9 8 7
 ♦ J 9 6 3
 ♣ 9 5

♠ K Q 5
 ♥ A 6 3
 ♦ A 8 2
 ♣ A J 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ T 8 4 3
 ♥ J 5 2
 ♦ T 4
 ♣ K T 8 6

♠ A J 2
 ♥ K Q 4
 ♦ K Q 7 5
 ♣ Q 7 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	6NT		1NT
All Pass 6NT by South			

Baker SecondHand 13
 [show NE]

[showcards S:H4]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ! H10, won by dummy's ♥A. At trick 2 South calls for dummy's ♣3. Which card do you play?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
 [NEXT]

[show NESW]

Play the ♣6.

You would not have been expecting South to play a small ♣ from dummy's holding. The only way it makes sense is if South holds the ♣Q.

If you play your ♣K you will win the trick, but in so doing you will set up 3 ♣ tricks for South, which is all he needs to make the slam.

Play low instead and South will win his ♣Q. But now your ♣K 10 sits behind dummy's ♣J 4 so he can get only one more trick in the suit, the ♣A.

Board 14

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J T 9 6
 ♥ -
 ♦ T 8 6 4 3
 ♣ A 8 4 3

♠ K 7 2
 ♥ K J T 9 3
 ♦ 7 2
 ♣ K J T



♠ 8 4 3
 ♥ 7 4
 ♦ Q J 9 5
 ♣ Q 9 7 5

♠ A Q 5
 ♥ A Q 8 6 5 2
 ♦ A K
 ♣ 6 2

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	6♥
All Pass 6♥ by South			

Baker SecondHand 14

[show NW]

[showcards E:S3,H7,H4 S:S5,HA,H2,C2]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♠J, the ♠K is played from dummy and holds the trick. Next come dummy's ♥K, then another trump to South's ♥A.

At trick 4 South plays the ♣2 from his hand and you must decide what to play.

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
 [NEXT]

[show NESW]

Play the ♣3 (smoothly).

South has 2 small ♣s and faces a choice of dummy plays in the suit. He must decide whether to play you for the ♣A or the ♣Q. If you play your ♣A you make the decision very easy for him.

When you correctly play your small ♣ life becomes harder for South. Sometimes he will guess correctly and play dummy's ♣K, but other times he will play dummy's ♣J, hoping you have the ♣Q.

Board 15

South Deals

None Vul

♠ T 8 7 6 2

♥ T 5 4

♦ K 6

♣ J 9 6

♠ 5 4

♥ J 6 2

♦ J 8 5 2

♣ A K Q 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 9 3

♥ Q 9 8

♦ A 7 3

♣ T 8 5 4

♠ K Q J

♥ A K 7 3

♦ Q T 9 4

♣ 7 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

1NT

All Pass
3NT by South

Baker SecondHand 15

[show NE]

[showcards S:SQ,SJ,C3 W:S6,S2,C6]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♠6. You won the ♠A and returned the ♠9, won by South's ♠Q.

South next played to dummy's ♣A and led the ♦2. What do you play?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.

[NEXT]

[show NESW]

Play the ♦A.

Count the points. South's 15-17 plus North's 11 plus your 10 comes to 36-38. So West has room for an Ace or a King, but no more.

West's second ♠ play was the 2, so it looks like he started with 5 ♠s. And the fall of South's ♠s looks like he may have 1 ♠ left, very likely the ♠K.

All this means that you should take your ♦A now and return your last ♠ to establish West's suit. Now West's ♦K will be an entry to the ♠s

If you play low, West will have to take the ♦K now, and although he can play a ♠ to establish the suit, he will not have an entry to be able to cash them.

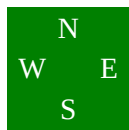
Board 16

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 4
♥ A 2
♦ T 6 4 3
♣ Q J T 7 5

♠ K Q 8 6
♥ K 7 5 3
♦ A Q 5
♣ 8 4



♠ 5 2
♥ Q J T
♦ J 9 8 2
♣ 9 6 3 2

♠ A J T 7 3
♥ 9 8 6 4
♦ K 7
♣ A K

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
Pass	4 ♠	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass 6 ♠ by South			

Baker SecondHand 16

[show NESW]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♣Q, East plays low and South wins the ♣A.

South pulls trumps in 2 rounds. He then takes the ♦K, ♦Q, ♦A, discarding a ♥ on the last one. Next he plays dummy's last ♣ to his ♣K.

Having done all this, South now plays a low ♥ from his hand. What do you play?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
[NEXT]

Play the ♥A.

If you followed what South was doing you will realize that he has eliminated both the ♦s and ♣s from both his hand and dummy. If it isn't clear that he is now out of ♣s, just remember the bidding - he must have had 5 ♠s and 4 ♥s.

Suppose you play low on this ♥ (as South hopes you will). Dummy's ♥K will take the trick, and when another ♥ is played you will have to win it with your now bare ♥A. You will then have to play a ♦ or a ♣, giving South a ruff and sluff.

But if you take your ♥A now, then exit with your ♥2, South can win the ♥K but will still have to lose a ♥ to East.

Board 17

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 9 5

♥ -

♦ 9 6 4 2

♣ 9 6 5 3

♠ T 7 2

♥ J 8 7 3 2

♦ A K Q

♣ A K



♠ 8 4 3

♥ Q T 4

♦ 8 7 3

♣ J 8 7 4

♠ A 6

♥ A K 9 6 5

♦ J T 5

♣ Q T 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♦

Pass

3NT

Pass

6♥

All Pass
6♥ by South

Baker SecondHand 17

[show NE]

[showcards S:SA,C2 W:SK]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

West led the ♠K, won by South's ♠A. South played a small ♣ to dummy's ♣A, then led dummy's ♥J.

What do you play? ♥Q or ♥4?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
[NEXT]

[show NESW]

Play the ♥4.

Remember that South opened 1♥, so he has 5 of them. With only 3 trumps out he has no intention of finessing. Perhaps he led the ♥J just to tempt you to cover in this situation.

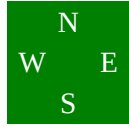
If you play low he will win with one of his high ♥s and then you will have a sure ♥ winner. Along with the ♠ winner West has you will defeat the slam.

If you cover the ♥J with your ♥Q South will again win with one of his high ones. But now the position will be clear to South and he will return to dummy and play another ♥, finessing your ! H10. With no trump loser he will make the slam.

Board 18
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ A 9 5 2
 ♥ 7 2
 ♦ 8 6 4
 ♣ T 8 5 3

♠ Q J 6
 ♥ T 5 4
 ♦ A K 3
 ♣ A Q 7 4



♠ K T 7 4
 ♥ A 3
 ♦ J T 9 2
 ♣ K J 9

♠ 8 3
 ♥ K Q J 9 8 6
 ♦ Q 7 5
 ♣ 6 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	4♥		2♥
All Pass 4♥ by South			

[show NESW]

[PLAY S:D6]

Play the ♠A.

Even if South doesn't have the ♠K he can establish a ♠ winner just by leading twice toward the ♠ Q J. That winner will take care of whatever black-suit loser he may have.

If East has a ♣ trick it is important to get it established soon. So go up with the ♠A and play a ♣ through dummy's ♣ A Q. When South tries the ♠ suit again EAST can win and cash his ♣K for the setting trick.

If you play low on South's ♠ play East will be forced to win the trick and he cannot profitably attack the ♣ suit from his side.

Baker SecondHand 18
 [show NW]

[showcards E:HA,H3,DJ S:S3,HK,H6,D6]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You decide a trump lead is called for and lead the ♥2. Your partner wins with the ♥A and plays the ♦J. South lets this go to dummy's ♦K, (but you know he has ♦Q), then plays a trump back to his ♥K, pulling the 2 outstanding trumps from West and East.

South's next play is the ♠3 from his hand. Do you play your ♠A or not?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
 [NEXT]

Board 19
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ J 9 4 2
 ♥ 7 3
 ♦ T 7 5
 ♣ Q T 6 5

♠ 6
 ♥ Q J 9 6
 ♦ Q 6 3
 ♣ A 7 4 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A T 8 7 3
 ♥ T 4
 ♦ K J 8 4
 ♣ 9 8

♠ K Q 5
 ♥ A K 8 5 2
 ♦ A 9 2
 ♣ K J

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♦	Pass	6 ♥
All Pass 6 ♥ by South			

Baker SecondHand 19
 [show NE]

[showcards S:HA,H2 W:H7,H3]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥3, you play ! H10 and South wins the ♥A. South pulls the last two trumps by leading low to dummy's ♥Q. He now calls for the ♠6. Will you play your ♠A or not?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
 [NEXT]

[show NESW]

Play the ♠3.

When a singleton in dummy is led through your Ace it is more often better to play low than to go up with the Ace. Declarer might not even have the King, or he may have the King Jack combination and guess wrong.

Here it works out best to play low even though South has the ♠ K Q 5.

Assume you play your ♠A. South will play his loser, of course, and later will be able to discard two of dummy's ♦s on the ♠ K Q. He can then ruff his two ♦ losers and make the contract.

Now assume you play low. South will play the ♠Q which will win the trick and he will no longer have a ♠ loser. BUT - now he will have no way to dispose of the two ♦ losers and will go down 1.

Board 20

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ K 5
♦ J T 9 5 4
♣ 9 8 6 2

♠ K Q T 3
♥ J 8 7 4
♦ A 3
♣ A K 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7 2
♥ Q T 3
♦ Q 8 6 2
♣ J T 5 4

♠ A J 9 6 5
♥ A 9 6 2
♦ K 7
♣ Q 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3♠
Pass	6♠		
All Pass 6♠ by South			

Baker SecondHand 20

[show NESW]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♦ J and dummy's ♦ A wins the first trick. Declarer pulls trumps with dummy's ♠ K, then his ♠ A. He then plays his ♦ K and follows with ♣ Q, ♣ K and ♣ A, discarding a ♥ from his hand on the last.

With all that completed South plays the ♥ A. What do you play?

When you have made your choice click NEXT.
[NEXT]

Play the ♥ K.

It may look foolish to waste your ♥ K but look what will happen if you don't. South will follow up with another ♥ and when you win the ♥ K you will be forced to play a minor suit. Since both North and South are out of ♦ s and ♣ s you will be giving them a ruff-sluff and the contract.

But if you dump your ♥ K under South's ♥ A look at what's left. South has ♥ losers and when he plays a ♥ from either hand East will scoop up two tricks with his ♥ Q 10.